

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Threat Detection and Response | Threat Hunting | Detection Engineering | Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of hands-on experience in cyber defence operations, Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) tooling, incident response leadership, threat hunting, and detection engineering. At the University of the Arts London, I have led the maturation of security monitoring and response capabilities across an enterprise environment of more than 8,000 users, building and tuning detection rules, leading complex incident response investigations, conducting hypothesis-driven threat hunting exercises, and managing vulnerability remediation programmes. I bring a proven ability to combine proactive and reactive security disciplines, working collaboratively with technical and non-technical stakeholders to enhance cyber resilience across a large organisation. I am now seeking a senior analyst role in a global professional services environment where I can continue to develop enterprise-wide cyber security operations and play a key part in shaping and maturing the security function.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel and Kusto Query Language (KQL), custom correlation rule development, alert tuning and lifecycle management, dashboard and workbook development
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR/XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Prevent, Insight, Discover) - Expert level
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61 incident response lifecycle, forensic investigation, post-incident reporting
- **Threat Hunting:** Hypothesis-driven hunting using MITRE ATT&CK Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs), telemetry analysis, behavioural baselining
- **Threat Modelling:** MITRE ATT&CK-based threat modelling to inform detection priorities and security posture improvements
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, penetration test findings management and remediation
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Automated playbook development in Microsoft Sentinel, PowerShell scripting for alert enrichment and response
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Active Directory (AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM
- **Email Security:** Mimecast (anti-phishing, sandboxing, Data Loss Prevention (DLP))
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Monitor, investigate, and respond to cyber security alerts and incidents across Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), leading the full end-to-end incident response lifecycle in line with NIST SP 800-61
- Build and tune detection rules and correlation logic within Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL), improving detection coverage across MITRE ATT&CK Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs) and reducing alert fatigue by systematically removing false positives

- Conduct hypothesis-driven threat hunting exercises using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), proactively identifying threats that evade automated detection
- Develop and iterate threat models using the MITRE ATT&CK framework to inform detection priorities, identify coverage gaps, and support ongoing improvements to the organisation's security posture
- Lead vulnerability remediation activities using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, and AppCheck, working with IT and infrastructure teams to prioritise and track findings through to closure
- Support and manage penetration testing activities, triaging findings, coordinating remediation, and producing executive and technical reporting on security exposure
- Develop Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to automate repetitive response tasks and accelerate mean time to respond (MTTR)
- Collaborate with technical and non-technical stakeholders across IT and the business to communicate investigation findings, risk exposure, and remediation priorities clearly and effectively
- Mentor junior security analysts, reviewing their alert investigations and supporting skill development across the team

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Triaged and investigated security alerts generated by Microsoft Sentinel SIEM and CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, systematically tuning detection rules to reduce false positive rates and improve fidelity
- Led incident response investigations using NIST SP 800-61 methodology, conducting forensic analysis, producing detailed post-incident reports, and implementing lessons-learned improvements to detection and response processes
- Developed over 30 custom Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, covering adversary Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs) including lateral movement, credential theft, persistence, and data exfiltration
- Performed threat hunting across endpoint and network telemetry using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), identifying previously undetected threats and improving defensive coverage
- Managed vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and AppCheck, coordinating remediation with infrastructure and development teams and tracking progress against agreed risk targets
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) to detect and alert on identity-based attack patterns including credential stuffing, pass-the-hash, and Kerberoasting across the Active Directory (AD) estate
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Active Directory (AD), Conditional Access policies, and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) to enforce identity security controls for 8,000-plus users
- Supported BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) deployment and ongoing governance, ensuring all administrative access was appropriately controlled and audited
- Developed PowerShell scripts and SOAR automations to streamline alert enrichment, reduce manual triage steps, and accelerate response workflows

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Supported security monitoring and incident investigation activities, contributing to alert triage and root cause analysis across cloud and on-premises environments
- Administered cloud security controls within Microsoft Azure and Microsoft 365, including identity and access management and endpoint protection configuration
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and maintained patch management processes to reduce exposure across the technology estate
- Assisted with IT infrastructure security hardening and contributed to compliance activities aligned to industry security standards

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built over 30 custom Microsoft Sentinel Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules covering MITRE ATT&CK Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs), improving detection coverage and reducing false positive rate by approximately 35 per cent

- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) across 8,000-plus endpoints, achieving full endpoint visibility and sub-one-minute detection times for known threat patterns
- Established a structured threat hunting programme using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and MITRE ATT&CK, identifying and remediating five previously undetected threats within the first quarter of operation
- Led incident response for a complex phishing and credential-theft attack, successfully containing the threat within two hours and producing a full post-incident report with remediation recommendations that strengthened the organisation's defences
- Implemented a vulnerability management programme using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, and AppCheck, reducing critical and high-severity exposure by 60 per cent within 12 months
- Developed automated Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel that reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) to security incidents by approximately 40 per cent

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)